

Intentional Rescue

A STUDY IN STANCE

1ST REPORT – DESIGN OF PHYSICALLY GROUNDED COMMUNICATION SYSTEM

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Play the film first.

NO EXPLANATION. LET THE ROOM READ IT.

75 seconds. Two robots. A wall.

We attribute intention to the shapes before any
commentary — that attribution is the subject of the talk.

The Rescue.

TWO ROBOTS, SEPARATED. ONE FINDS A WAY BACK.

TOGETHER

two robots breathe in the same room.

SEPARATION

a wall rises. Friend dims. Hero pauses.

DELIBERATION

Hero considers two possible futures.

JOURNEY

Hero ignores a sparkle, re-routes around a new wall.

REUNION

Hero arrives. Friend brightens. They breathe together.

Six hints, five beats.

FROM DIST-04, MAPPED TO WHERE THE FILM SHOWS IT.

INTENTION HINT

Tries to achieve a goal

Acts consciously

Persists; does not give up

Focuses on the main target

Simulates future worlds

Models other agent / self

WHERE IT APPEARS

Throughout. Hero moves only toward Friend.

Beat 3. Hero pauses before moving.

Beat 4. Wall 2 rises; Hero re-plans.

Beat 4. The sparkle drifts past, ignored.

Beat 3. Two ghost paths flicker.

Throughout. Plan is against Friend's pose.

Two readings, side by side.

THE VIEWER ATTRIBUTES; THE CHYRON CONFIRMS.

EXTERNAL – INTENTIONAL STANCE

The viewer sees discs
and tells a story: she
got hurt, he is going
around to reach her.

Heider & Simmel, 1944.

Dennett, 1971.

The point is the alignment:
what the chyron names, the viewer's reading also names.

INTERNAL – BELIEF / DESIRE / PLAN

A chyron exposes what
the agent holds:
belief: friend is across
desire: reach the friend
plan: go above

Baker et al., 2017.

How the film was made.

FRAMES GENERATED PROGRAMMATICALLY – NO SCREEN RECORDING.

PYGAME

anti-aliased discs and lines.

NUMPY / SCIPY

bloom, motion trails, paper grain.

IMAGEIO-FFMPEG

streams frames to mp4 — 75 s at 30 fps.

TYPOGRAPHY

Charter + Avenir Next (deck and film share the same faces).

CODE

github.com/nanase1025/intentional-rescue

What I would like evaluated.

THREE ANGLES, IN ORDER OF IMPORTANCE.

1. *Alignment.*

Does your external reading agree with the BDI chyron at each beat?

2. *Restraint.*

Intention is conveyed without faces, language, or scored music.

3. *Scope.*

I stop at goal-directed individual action.
Communication is deliberately out of frame.

What the film does not show.

DRAWING THE PERIMETER IS PART OF THE DESIGN.

No communication.

joint attention sits later in the course.

No Bayesian inference.

the agent is a finite plan, not a posterior.

No nested mentalising.

Hero models the Friend's pose, not mind.

No physical grounding.

no sensors — a thought-experiment, not a robot.

Watch it again.

NOW THE LABELS ARE IN YOUR HEAD.

Same 75 seconds. Same shapes.

The reading shifts — each attribution
is now tied to a belief, desire, or plan.

Reading behind the film.

ALL ON THE SYLLABUS.

Dennett. Intentional Systems. J. Phil. 68, 1971.

Cohen & Levesque. Intention is Choice with
Commitment. Artif. Intell. 42, 1990.

Baker, Jara-Ettinger, Saxe & Tenenbaum.
Rational quantitative attribution of beliefs,
desires and percepts. Nat. Hum. Behav. 1, 2017.

Heider & Simmel. Apparent Behavior.
Am. J. Psych. 57, 1944.

Epley, Waytz & Cacioppo. On Seeing Human.
Psych. Review 114, 2007.

THANK YOU.